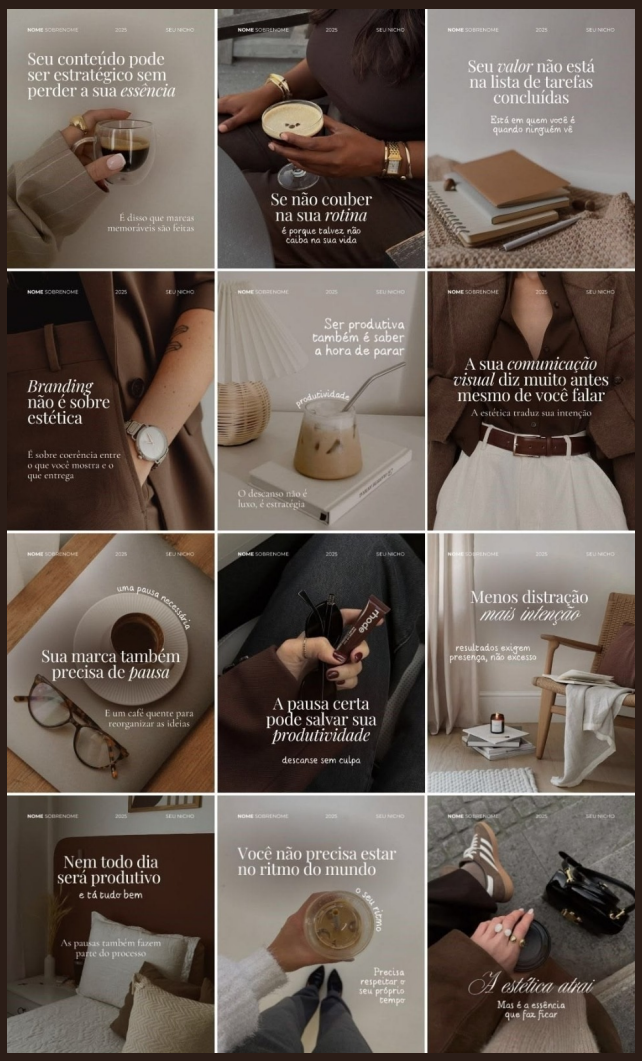
CASE STUDY | EDITORIAL SOCIAL DESIGN

Quiet Luxury
Instagram Feed

A warm, editorial carousel system on branding, rest and intention, written in Brazilian Portuguese.



ROLE
Social Media Designer

DELIVERABLE
12 slide feed system

PLATFORM
Instagram feed

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

A feed that feels like a slow morning

This project is a 12 slide Instagram carousel system for a personal brand or creator in the branding, productivity and lifestyle space. Every slide pairs a single calm thought with a styled lifestyle photograph: coffee, notebooks, tailored jackets, soft interiors. The result is a feed that sells a mindset first and the service second. The header strip (NOME SOBRENOME, 2025, SEU NICHO) is built as a placeholder, so the whole system works as a customisable template.

Project	Instagram carousel and grid system, 12 slides
Language	Brazilian Portuguese
Theme	Branding, mindful productivity, rest and intention
Format	Portrait feed posts with a consistent header strip
Role	Art direction, photo selection, typography, layout and final design

Skills used

Art direction	Defining a warm, minimal and editorial look from a restrained palette.
Typographic design	Pairing an elegant serif with italic emphasis and a handwritten accent.
Image curation	Choosing and cropping photos so each one leaves clean space for words.
Copy hierarchy	Setting headline, supporting line and tag so each slide reads in seconds.
Systems thinking	Building one grid with repeatable text positions for fast production.

Deliverables

- 12 finished carousel slides with Portuguese copy.
- A consistent header strip with name, year and niche fields ready to customise.
- A defined palette, type pairing and photography direction.
- A balanced profile grid, planned as a 3 by 4 composition.

Look expensive without shouting

Personal brand feeds in the coaching, design and creator space often rely on bright colours, heavy graphics and dense text. The goal here was the opposite: an understated feed where mood, tone and restraint communicate quality.

Key problems

- **Standing out quietly.** A neutral palette can feel flat unless texture and rhythm are planned.
- **Text on photos.** Lifestyle images are busy, so words need safe zones to stay readable.
- **Consistency.** Twelve different photos had to feel like one brand.
- **Message depth.** Short lines had to carry a real idea, not just decoration.

Goals

Cohesion	One tonal world of browns, creams and soft light across every post.
Credibility	Signal taste and professionalism through restraint and typography.
Connection	Use reflective, human copy that makes followers feel understood.
Scalability	Make the system easy to repeat for future content and other niches.

Audience

- Women entrepreneurs and creatives who value aesthetics and intentional work.
- Followers tired of hustle culture who respond to calm, balanced messaging.
- Potential clients who judge a brand by how considered its visuals are.

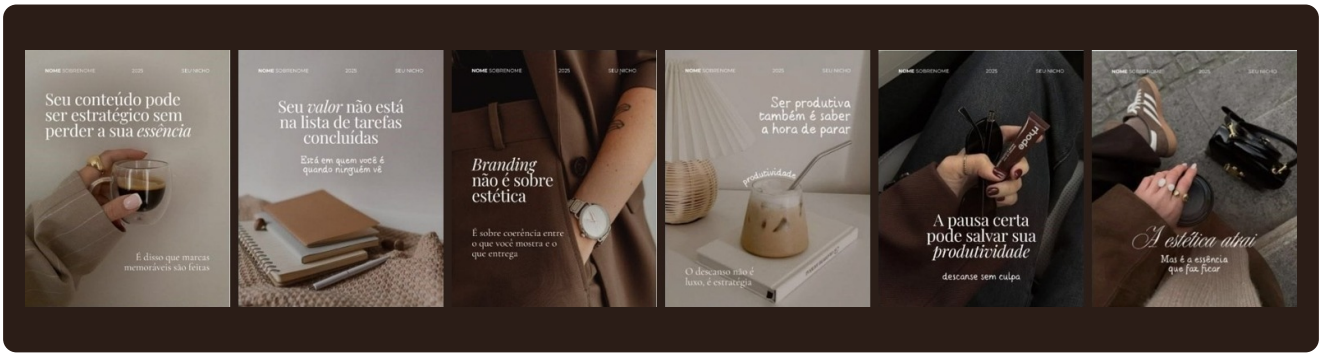
Three themes, one voice

The copy moves between three connected themes. Each is shown through its own kind of image, so the grid has variety while the voice stays steady.

Theme	Message	Photography
Branding with substance	Strategy and aesthetics must serve the real essence of the person behind the brand.	Tailoring, watch, jacket and office textures
Productivity with rest	Pauses are part of the work. Rest is a strategy, not a luxury.	Coffee, glasses, drinks and soft interiors
Worth beyond output	Your value is not measured by task lists, and not every day must be productive.	Notebooks, beds, cushions and quiet moments

Why this works

- The tone is gentle and permission giving, which builds trust faster than urgency.
- Each slide has one idea, so it can be saved, shared or screenshotted on its own.
- Italic words in each headline mark the emotional core of the sentence.



A palette borrowed from coffee and cashmere

Espresso
#2B1D17
Deep backgrounds, anchor tone

Mocha
#5A3E31
Jackets, wood, warmth

Caramel
#A9784F
Accents and highlights

Taupe
#B9AA9B
Soft neutral backdrops

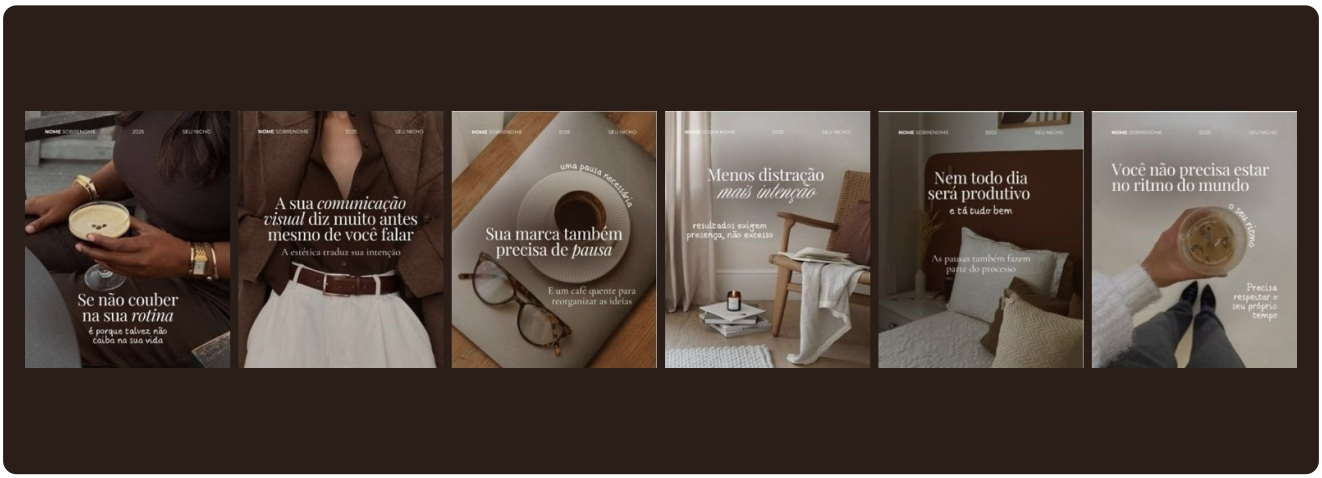
Cream
#EFE6DA
Light surfaces and breathing space

Typography

Headline serif	A high contrast display serif, set in sentence case. Key words switch to italic for emphasis (essência, rotina, pausa, intenção).
Handwritten accent	A light script used for small tags and curved labels such as produtividade, uma pausa necessária and o seu ritmo.
Supporting text	A refined serif in small sizes for the second line, with generous leading.
Header strip	A tiny sans serif line across the top: name, year and niche, in capitals.

Design principles

- Keep only one headline, one supporting line and one optional tag per slide.
- Place text in the quiet part of each photo, never over hands or faces.
- Use white or cream text with soft contrast, avoiding pure black and heavy shadows.
- Let the photograph do the decorating. No icons, stickers or borders.



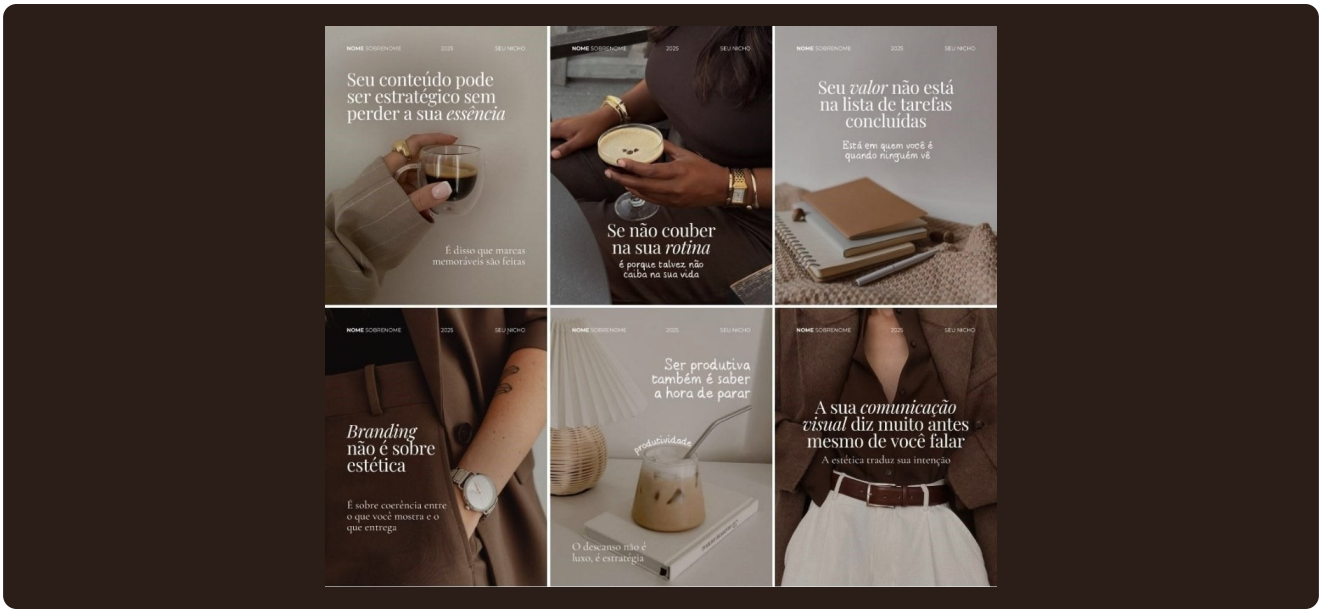
Six text positions rotate across the grid

Layout	Structure	Slides
A. Top left headline	Large serif headline top left, small supporting line bottom right.	01, 04
B. Bottom centre	Headline and caption rest at the base of the photo, over a darker area.	02, 08, 12
C. Centred statement	A centred headline floats in an open area of soft background.	03, 06, 11
D. Right aligned	Text hugs the right edge, away from the main object on the left.	05, 09
E. Lower left with arc tag	A curved script label hovers above the object, headline below.	07
F. Left lower stack	A headline and a handwritten note stacked near the left or bottom.	10

Grid rhythm

Because the profile shows three slides per row, positions and tones alternate so no two neighbouring tiles repeat. Light, mid and dark photographs are spread across each row, which keeps the grid balanced and avoids heavy clusters.

- Each row contains at least one lighter tile and one deeper tile.
- Text alignment shifts from left to centre to right as the eye moves across.
- The same header strip sits in the same place on every tile for a clean, repeatable frame.



Copy, translation and purpose

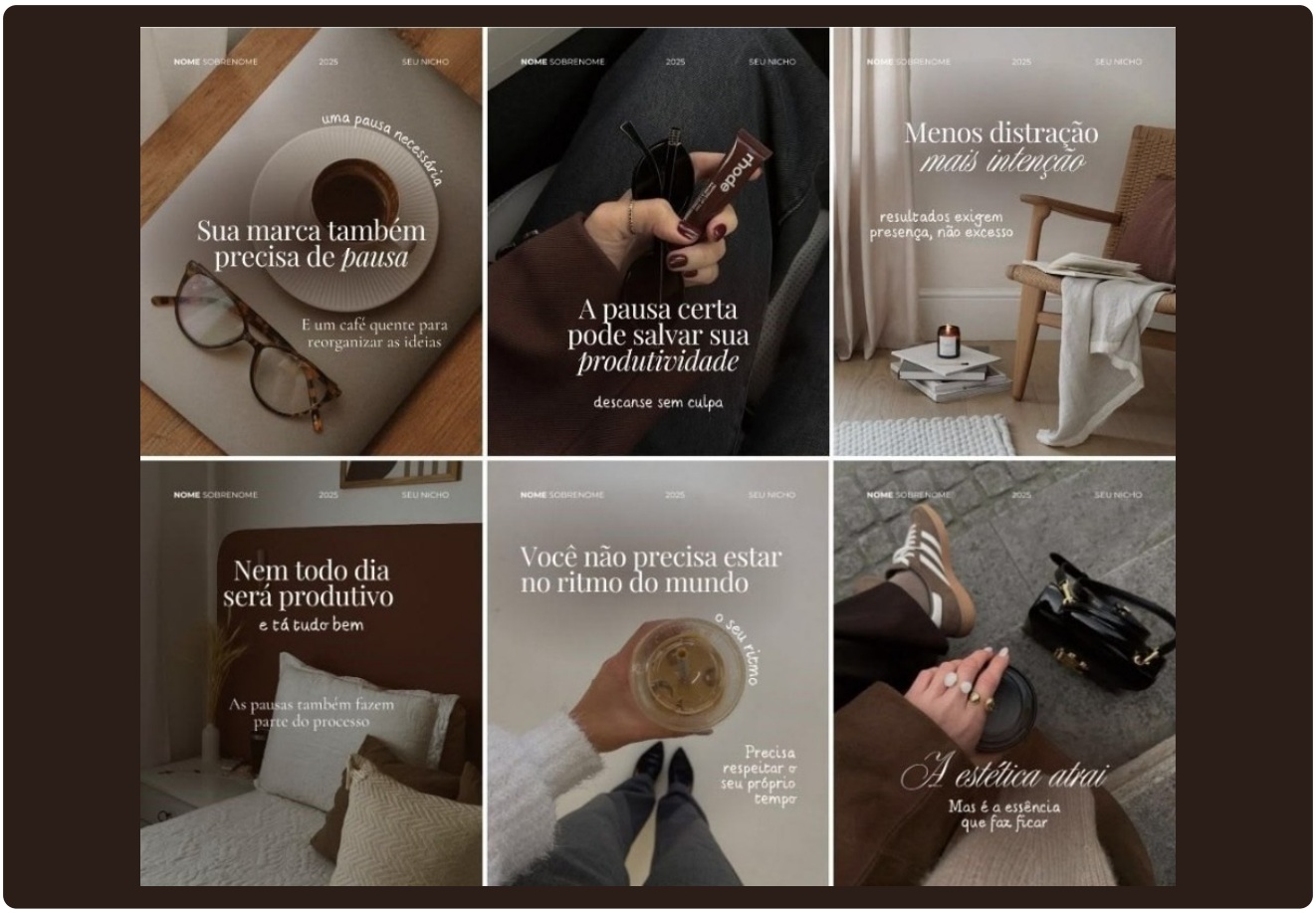
#	Headline	Meaning and role
01	*Seu conteúdo pode ser estratégico sem perder a sua essência*	Your content can be strategic without losing your essence. Opens the series with the core promise.
02	*Se não couber na sua rotina*	If it does not fit your routine, maybe it does not fit your life. A cocktail and watch shot adds sophistication.
03	*Seu valor não está na lista de tarefas concluídas*	Your worth is not in your finished to do list. A notebook still life supports the reflective tone.
04	*Branding não é sobre estética*	Branding is not about aesthetics. It is about coherence between what you show and what you deliver.
05	*Ser produtiva também é saber a hora de parar*	Being productive also means knowing when to stop. Rest is strategy.
06	*A sua comunicação visual diz muito antes mesmo de você falar*	Your visual communication speaks before you do. Aesthetics translates intention.
07	*Sua marca também precisa de pausa*	Your brand needs a pause too. A coffee and glasses to reorganise ideas.
08	*A pausa certa pode salvar sua produtividade*	The right pause can save your productivity. Rest without guilt.
09	*Menos distração, mais intenção*	Less distraction, more intention. Results ask for presence, not excess.
10	*Nem todo dia será produtivo*	Not every day will be productive, and that is okay. Pauses are part of the process.
11	*Você não precisa estar no ritmo do mundo*	You do not need to move at the world's pace. Respect your own rhythm.
12	*A estética atrai*	Aesthetics attracts, but essence is what makes people stay. A strong closing line.

07 PHOTOGRAPHY DIRECTION

Everyday objects, treated like editorial stills

The images follow a simple recipe, so even a mixed set of photos feels as if it was shot in one session.

Subjects	Coffee, espresso martini, iced latte, glasses, notebook, lamp, lip product, trainers and a bag.
Fashion cues	Tailored blazers, linen trousers, a watch, rings and bracelets, always in browns and creams.
Light	Soft and diffused, with gentle shadows. No harsh flash or high saturation.
Crops	Tight and intimate: hands, wrists, shoulders and objects. Faces are rarely the focus.
Colour grade	Slightly desaturated and warm, with lifted blacks for a film like softness.
Negative space	Every frame keeps a calm area where text can sit without fighting the image.



What the project shows

- **Restraint reads as quality.** A narrow palette and one idea per slide made the feed feel premium.
- **Typography does the heavy lifting.** Serif plus italic emphasis creates warmth without extra graphics.
- **Layout rotation keeps interest.** Six text positions give variety while the frame stays constant.
- **A template mindset.** Placeholder header fields make the system reusable for any niche.

Project snapshot

Format	Instagram carousel of 12 slides
System	Six text positions inside one constant frame
Profile grid	Balanced 3 by 4 composition
Designer's note	"Restraint is what makes a feed feel premium."

Design note by Tomisin, the designer of this project.

Tools

Design: Canva, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Figma and Adobe Express.
Content: CapCut, Meta Business Suite, Pinterest, plus Freepik or Envato for stock assets.

Let's design a feed that feels like you.
Social media design, carousels and brand led content.